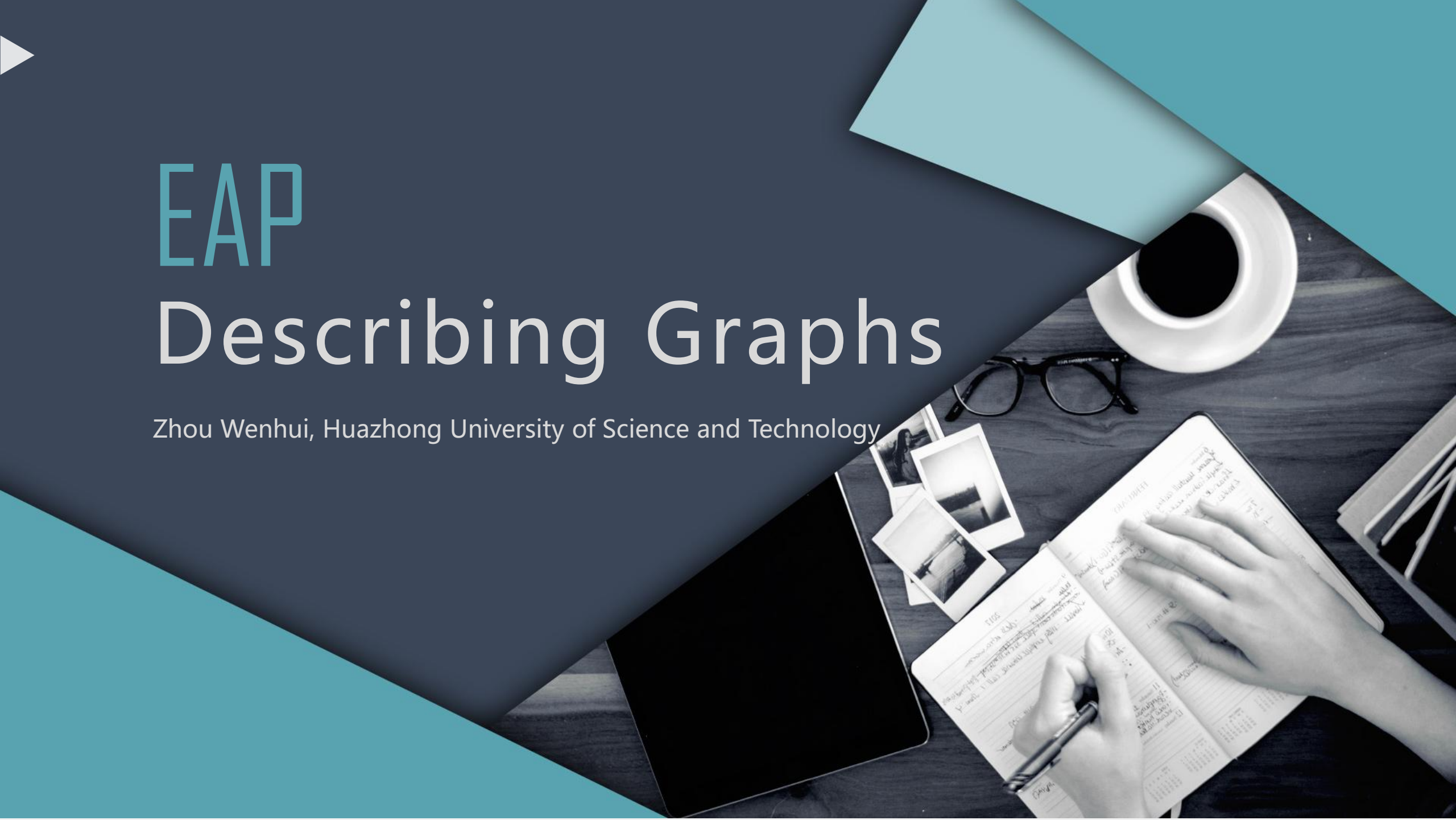




EAP

Describing Graphs

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02 Overview of the task

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CONTENTS



Types of Graphs

- ✓ Line Graphs
- ✓ Bar Charts
- ✓ Pie charts
- ✓ Tables



Overview of The Task



Step 1

A neutral introduction of what the graph contains.

Step 2

A description of the main finding(s).

Step 3

Some specific data that support the main finding(s).

Step 4

A Summary (optional)/An attempt to explain why the data show what they do. (Not required in IELTS writing.)

Sample Tasks

The line graph represents the number of enquiries made to a University Admissions Office from January to June 2021.

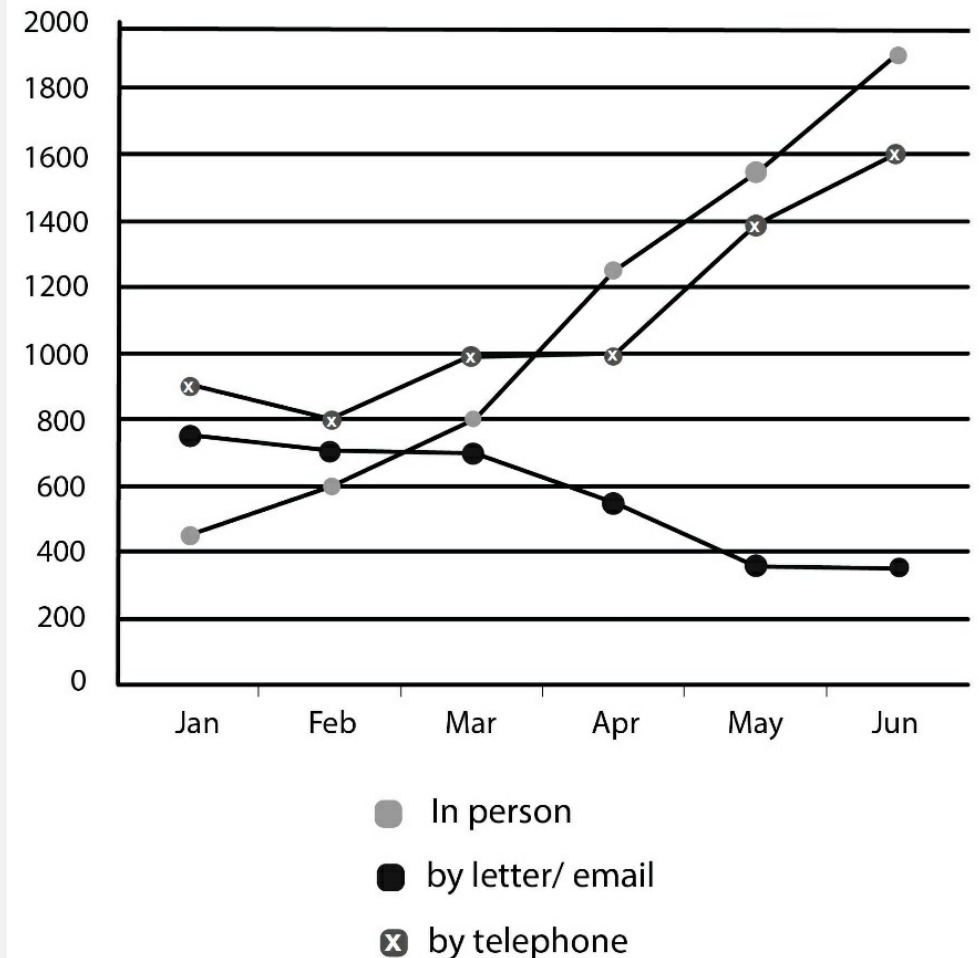
It is clear from the graph that the enquiries made in person and by telephone increased during this time, while the number of enquiries made by email decreased.

According to what is shown in the graph, in-person enquiries rose sharply from around 400 to 1900, while enquiries made by telephone showed a more gradual increase. Initially, telephone enquiries declined slightly from 900 to 800 enquiries, before increasing to 1000 in the third month. The ratio remained at this level for the month of April and then increased substantially in May and June to reach 1600 enquiries by the end of the period.

In contrast, enquiries by email showed an opposite trend, steadily declining from around 800 to around 400 enquiries over the 6-month period.

The graph below shows the number of enquiries received by a University Admissions Office over a six-month period in 2021.

Summarize the information by selecting and reporting the main features and make comparisons where relevant.

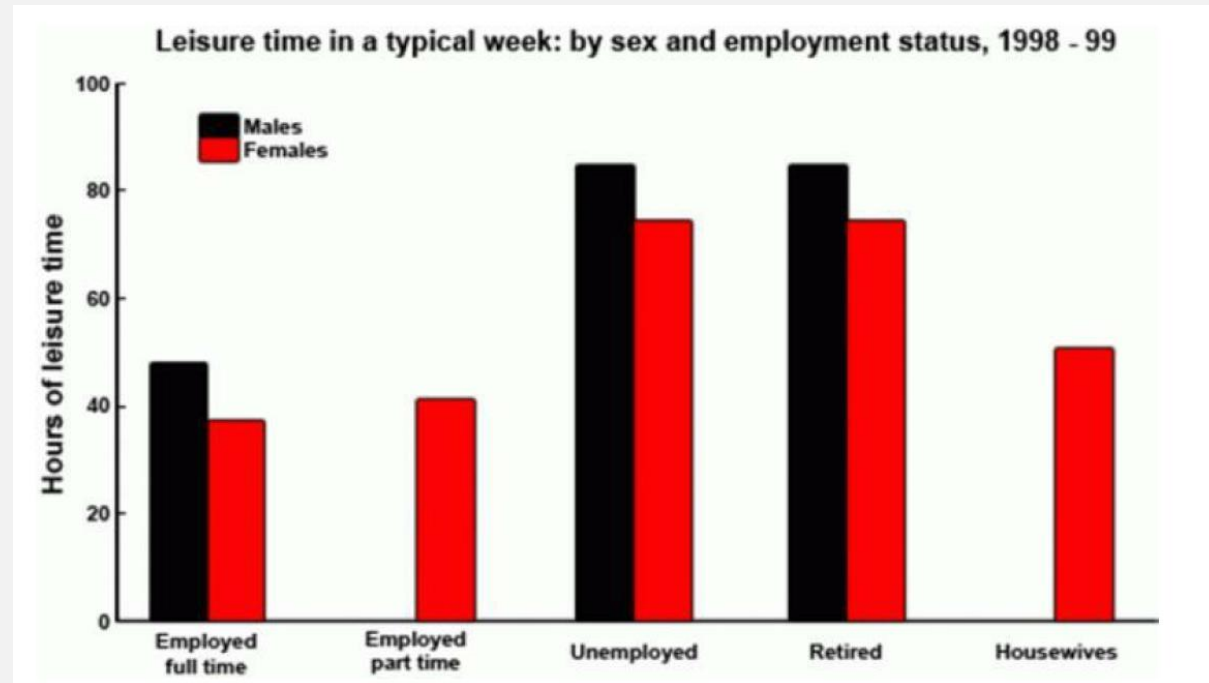


Sample Tasks

The bar chart compares the amount of free time per week that males and females of five categories of employment status had between 1998 and 1999.

It is clear that men enjoyed more hours of leisure time per week than women in three out of five categories. However, only figures for women are shown in two categories, namely employed part-time and housewives.

Regarding the full-time employed, obviously men had slightly more leisure time than women, with approximately 45 hours of free time per week, compared to around 38 hours for women. Obviously, unemployed and retired people of both genders enjoyed the most hours of leisure time. Moreover, the figures for retired males and females were exactly the same as those for the unemployed, at around 85 and 78 hours of free time per week, respectively. Housewives enjoyed 50 hours of spare time, a little more than part-time working women who had just over 40 leisure hours each week. No data is given for men in either of these categories.



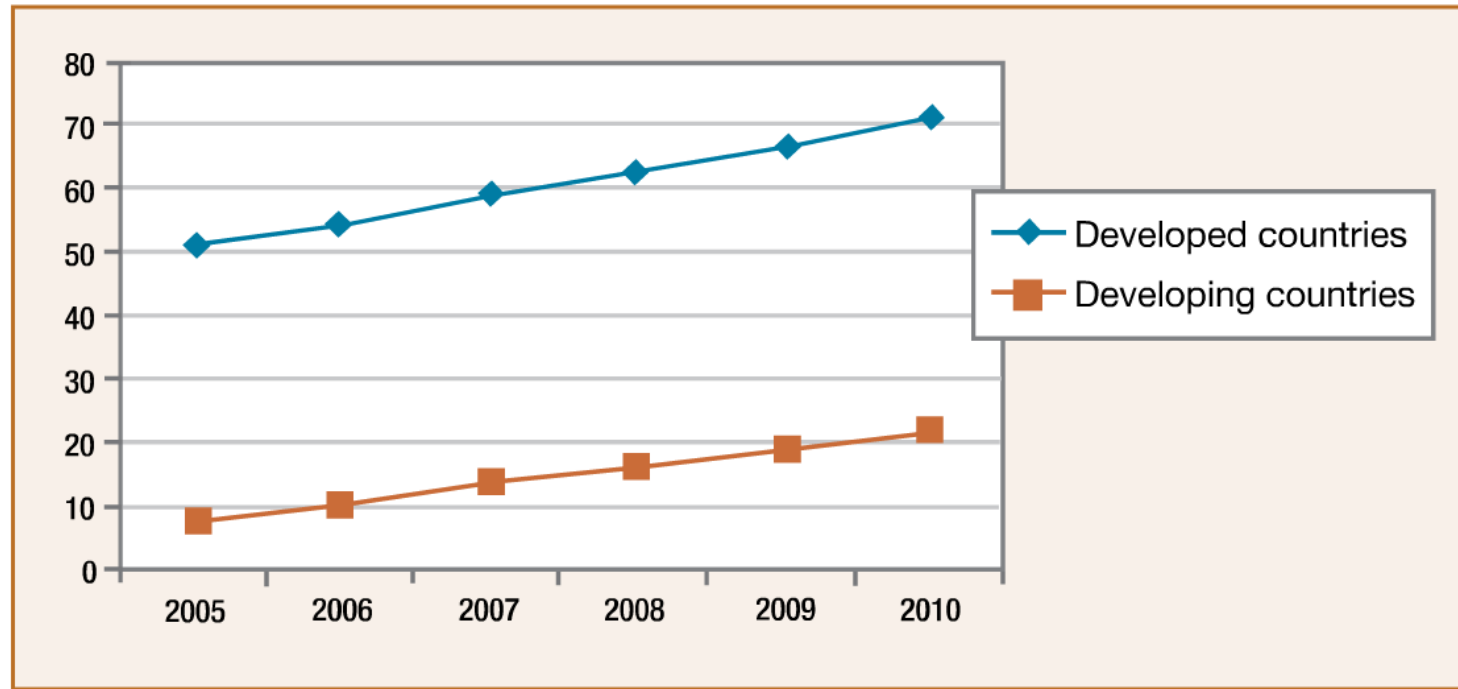
Writing Practice

1: How would you introduce the Graph?

2: What Key Trends can you see from the graph?

3: What specific details can you provide?

Figure 6.2. Internet use per 100 people



From Reading 1, Chapter 6, Book 1

Writing Practice

The line chart illustrates the number of internet users per 100 people in developed and developing countries over a six-year period from 2005 to 2010.

Overall, it is evident that internet usage increased steadily in both developed and developing countries during this period. However, the proportion of internet users was consistently higher in developed countries compared to developing countries, with a significant gap between the two regions.

In 2005, developed countries had approximately 50 internet users per 100 people, whereas the figure for developing countries was much lower at around 10 users per 100 people. Over the next five years, internet usage in developed countries grew steadily, reaching nearly 70 users per 100 people by 2010.

Similarly, the number of internet users in developing countries also increased steadily, but at a slower pace. By 2010, the figure for developing countries rose to just under 20 users per 100 people, which was still considerably lower than the rate in developed countries.

In summary, while both regions experienced an upward trend in internet usage, developed countries maintained a significantly higher level of internet coverage compared to developing countries throughout the period.

Introduction
(Topic, Timeline,
Categories)

**Key
Trends**

Data

Summary
(optional)

- Introduction (1–2 Sentences)
- Purpose: **Paraphrase** the graph's topic and scope.
- Key Structures:
 - Noun Phrase + Verb + Details:
 - *The (graph type) **shows/illustrates/compares/demonstrates** (topic) (timeline/categories).*
 - *The chart **provides an overview of**...*
 - **Passive Voice** (for process diagrams, if applicable):
 - *Data on ...(topic) is presented in the graph.*
- Example (Bar Chart):

"The bar chart compares the average monthly rainfall in three Southeast Asian countries (Thailand, Vietnam, and Malaysia) between 2010 and 2020."

- Overview of the key trends (2–3 Sentences)
- Purpose: Highlight the most significant trends **without specifics**.
- Analyze the Data:
 - ✓ **Identify Trends:** Look for increases, decreases, fluctuations, or stability (for **The Key Trends**).
 - ✓ **Compare Data Points:** Highlight contrasts between categories or time periods (for **Data Description**).
 - ✓ **Spot Outliers:** Note anomalies (e.g., a sudden drop in 2010 for **Data Description**).
- **Don't** go for the specifics:
 - If the graph or chart shows a time period (e.g. years), look for the **overall change** from the beginning to the end of the period (e.g. from the first year to the last year).
 - Look for **overall trends**, and **ignore individual figures that don't fit the trend**.
 - ✓ If a graph shows a rising trend overall, you can ignore a specific year when the figures decreased (save that year for your 'details' paragraphs).
 - **Don't look for individual 'highest' or 'lowest' figures** such as a 'peak' on a line graph. Instead, describe the highest and lowest items overall (e.g. which line on the graph was the highest for the whole or most of the period?).

- Start this part with a simple phrase that clearly shows that this is your summary paragraph
 - ✓ It is clear that...
 - ✓ It is noticeable that...
 - ✓ Overall, we can see that...
- Key Structures:
 - General Trends:
 - ✓ Overall, A experienced the most dramatic change, while B remained stable.
 - ✓ The most notable trend is the sharp increase in...
 - Comparisons:
 - ✓ In contrast to A, B showed minimal growth.
- An Example (Line Graph):

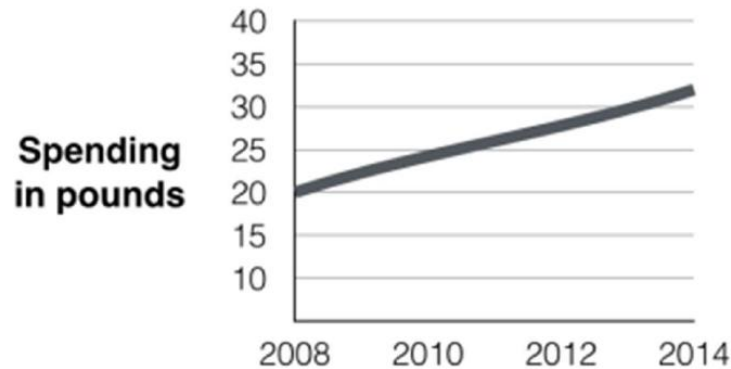
"Overall, carbon emissions in the U.S. declined steadily from 2005 to 2020, whereas emissions in China surged during the same period. Notably, India's emissions fluctuated but ended at a level similar to its starting point."
- Grammar Tip: Use **present perfect tense** for trends spanning a period up to the present ("has risen"), and **simple past** for completed time frames ("peaked in 2010").

1 & 2

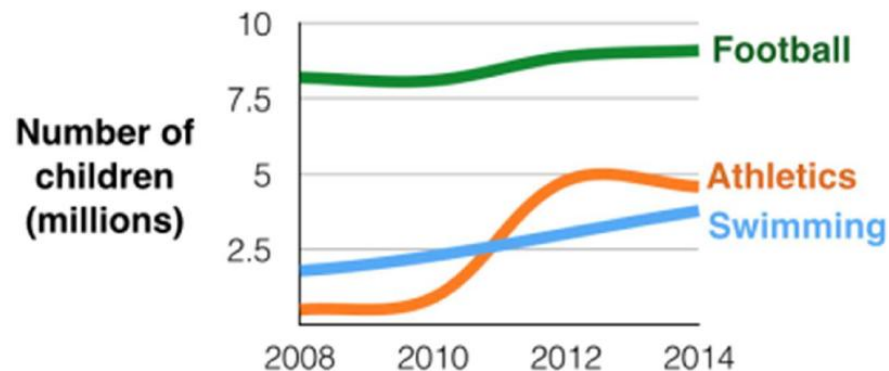
Writing Practice

The first chart below gives information about the money spent by British parents on their children's sports between 2008 and 2014. The second chart shows the number of children who participated in three sports in Britain over the same time period.

Average monthly spend on children's sports



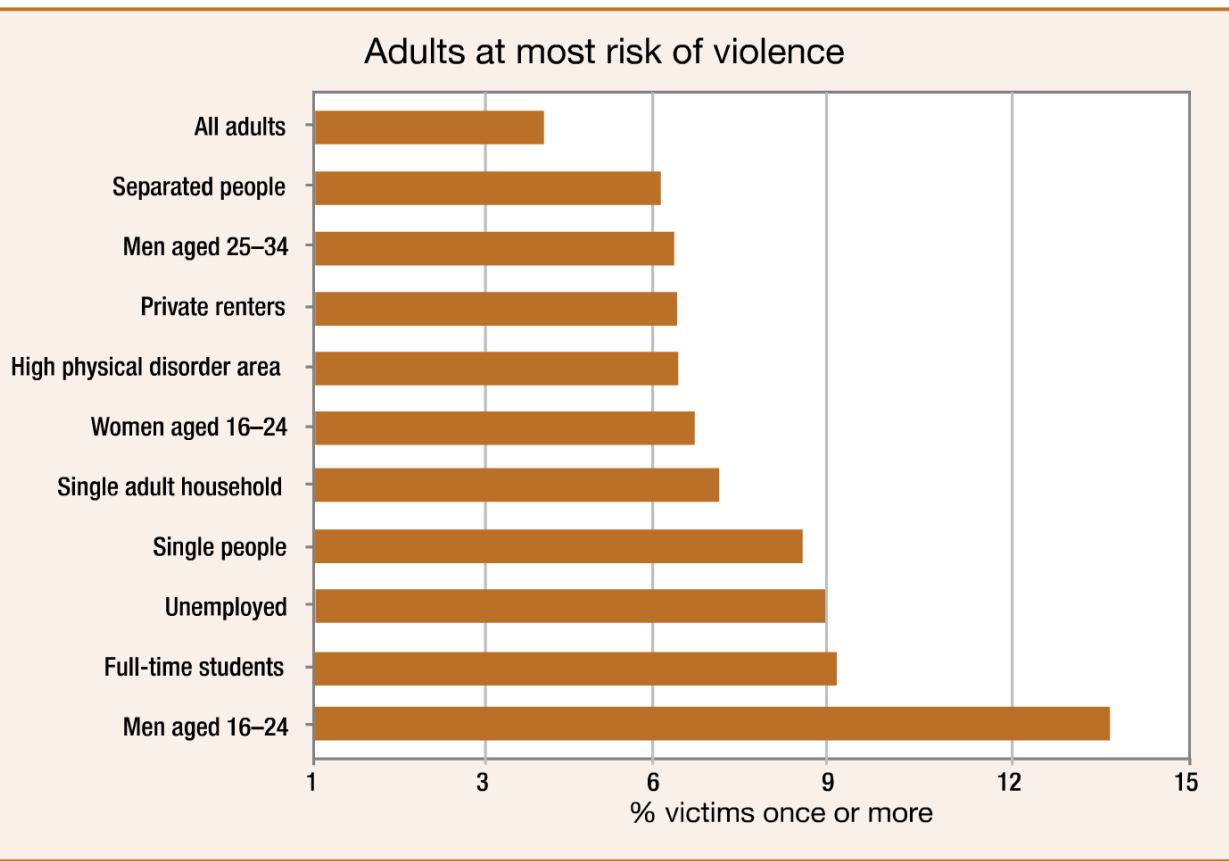
Participation in three different sports



The line graphs show the average monthly amount that parents in Britain spent on their children's sporting activities and the number of British children who took part in three different sports from 2008 to 2014.

It is clear that parents spent more money each year on their children's participation in sports over the six-year period. **In terms of** the number of children taking part, football was significantly more popular than athletics and swimming.

Figure 7.2. Risk factors for violence



Sample 1: **The bar chart illustrates** the percentage of adults at most risk of violence, according to various demographic factors. The data is presented as the proportion of victims who have experienced violence once or more. **Overall, it is clear that** men aged 16–24 face the highest risk of violence, while the percentage for all adults is significantly lower. Other groups with elevated risks include full-time students, the unemployed, and single people.

Sample 2: **The bar chart shows** the percentage of adults in different demographic groups who reported experiencing violence at least once. The data highlights key risk factors associated with violence exposure.

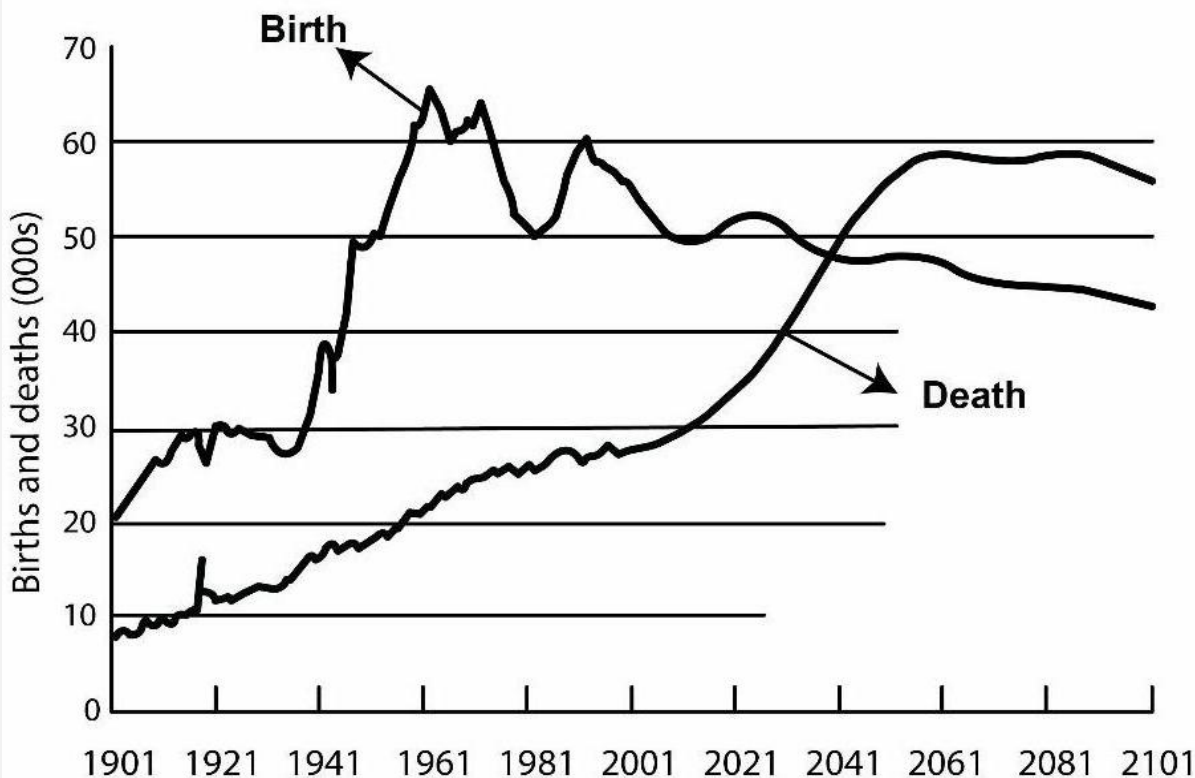
Overall, younger age groups, particularly men aged 16–24, face the highest risk of violence, while broader categories like "All adults" are the least affected. Studying full-time, being unemployed, and staying single also emerge as groups at significant risk.

1 & 2

Writing Practice

The graph below gives information about changes in the birth and death rates in New Zealand between 1901 and 2101.

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.



Sample 1: **The line graph shows** the historical and predicted trends for the rate of birth and mortality in New Zealand for the period from 1901 through to 2101.

Overall, the birth rate initially experienced a sharp rise before declining steadily after a peak in the mid-20th century. **In contrast**, the death rate showed a gradual increase throughout the period. **Notably**, the death rate is projected to surpass the birth rate around 2041, with this trend continuing until the end of the period.

Sample 2: **The line graph illustrates** the changes in birth and death rates in New Zealand over a 200-year period from 1901 to 2101. The figures are measured in thousands.

Overall, the birth rate shows a sharp rise followed by a steady decline, **while** the death rate rises gradually throughout the period. The rates intersect around 2041, with deaths outnumbering births thereafter.

1 & 2

Writing Practice

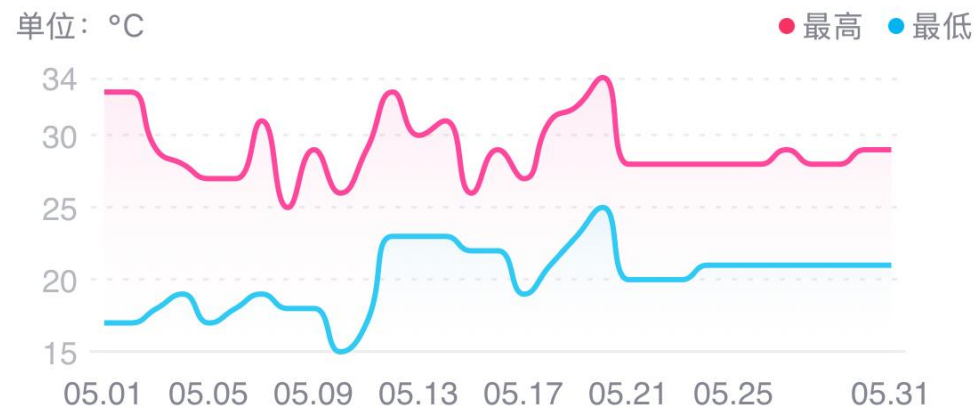
5月温度趋势图

平均最高温 29°C

平均最低温 20°C

最高温(5.20) 34°C

最低温(5.10) 15°C



武汉, 2025年5月

The line graph depicts the daily temperature fluctuations in Wuhan during May 2025, **highlighting** both average and extreme values.

Overall, temperatures in Wuhan vary significantly over the month, with the highest temperature far exceeding the average maximum, while the lowest temperature dropped notably below the average minimum. The data also reveals a substantial gap between the month's peak and trough temperatures.

- Support the key trends with precise data points from the graph (2-3 paragraphs).
 - ✓ **Quote numerical data:** Use actual figures to show the magnitude of changes.
 - ✓ **Focus on significant periods:** Highlight peaks, troughs, and intersections.
 - ✓ **Avoid describing every small fluctuation:** Prioritize major changes.
- Organizational Strategies:
 - **By Time:** "From 2000 to 2010...", "Following this period..."
 - **By Category:** "Regarding energy sources...", "In terms of regional differences..."
 - **By Extremes:** "The most striking feature is..."
- An example paragraph:

From 2000 to 2010, solar energy adoption in Germany rose gradually from 5% to 15%. However, after the introduction of government subsidies in 2012, growth accelerated sharply, reaching 40% by 2020. In contrast, France's solar adoption remained below 10% throughout the period, despite similar policy efforts.

Key Structures & Sentence Patterns:

- **Trend Description:**
 - **Noun + verb + adverb** from ... to
 - ✓ Coal consumption plummeted dramatically from 60% to 20% between 1990 and 2020.
 - Subject **experienced/witnessed/saw** a/an **adjective + noun** from... to....
 - ✓ The end of the period witnessed a gradual decline in the figures, dropping to 44,000 in 2012.
 - There was a/an **adjective + noun** in ... from... to...
 - ✓ There was a gradual decline in coal usage.
- **Comparisons:**
 - A was **comparative adjective** than B by...
 - ✓ Solar energy adoption was higher in Germany than in France by 20%.
 - In contrast to A, B...
 - ✓ In contrast to rural areas, urban regions saw a steeper rise in population by 12%.
- **Approximations (for estimated data):**
 - Approximately/Roughly n% of...
 - Just under/over half of...

Language Tips:

- **Use a range of verbs/nouns and adjectives/adverbs:**
 - Verbs: *grow, jump, rise, increase, improve, double, soar, surge, rocket; decrease, fall, drop, worsen, dip, plunge, plummet, halve; fluctuate, stabilize, recover, peak; go up, shoot up, go down, level off, bottom out, reach/hit a peak/trough.*
 - Adjectives: *steady, gradual, rapid, dramatical, considerable, sharp, significant, marginal, slight.*
- **Use cohesive devices:**
 - *Moreover, in contrast/comparison, although, however, similarly, during this period, whereas, while;*
 - *With respect to, in turns of, if we look at, as for, regarding.*
- **Avoid repetition:** Use synonyms and paraphrasing.
 - ✓ **Example:**
 - "The birth rate rises, and the death rate rises too."*
 - "While the birth rate experiences a sharp increase, the death rate grows more gradually."*



1



2.



3.



4.



5.



6.



7.



8.



9.



10.

1. Fell and then quickly recovered / Dipped/ fell slightly
2. Fell/dropped/shrank drastically/ dramatically / sharply/ Plummeted to/Plunged to
3. Dropped and then levelled off/evened out at
4. Rose/increased dramatically/Soared/ Rocketed
5. Hit a peak / Peaked at/reached a high of
6. Fluctuated/ was erratic
7. Hit a low of ...
8. Rose/increased steadily/ Rose/increased gradually
9. Remained flat/constant/unchanged/stable at
10. Fell gradually / steadily

- The U.S. produces over 2.2 billion tons of wheat every year. **In contrast**, Russia produces just over half a billion per year.
- Italy produced large amounts of dairy products. **In comparison**, Thailand produced very little.
- Finland imports some 10 million tons of flour per year, **but** produces none.
- **Although** Italy produces over 6 million tons of olives, Spain produces almost double that amount.
- Spain produces high levels of solar power, **whereas/while** Japan produces almost none.
- **While** Germany consumes nearly 80 million tons of rice per year, it produces none.

Rewrite these sentences using the linking phrases in brackets.

- 1 The income of Robbie's Bakery began at just under £60,000. (*with respect to*)
- 2 The amount of money which was earned by Bernie's Buns in 2000 was £20,000.
(*if we look at*)
- 3 The earnings of Robbie's Bakery remained stable during the first five years of the graph. (*as for*)
- 4 Income for Lovely Loaves fluctuated considerably between 2000 and 2005.
(*regarding*)

Another important way to write about comparatives is to use the structure '*x is not as + adjective + as y*'.

Coffee in France is not as expensive as in the UK.

Becoming confident using this structure will make your writing more flexible.

Look at these phrases and decide whether they express a big difference or a small one.

- 1 X is/was **nowhere near** as expensive as Y. *big difference*
- 2 X is/was **not quite** as expensive as Y.
- 3 X is/was **not nearly** as expensive as Y.
- 4 X is/was **almost** as expensive as Y.

Rewrite the comparative sentences below using *not as* + adjective (from the box) + *as*.

expensive

high

popular

successful

- 1 Monster Hits Records sold 230,000 CDs in 1990, whereas Crooners plc sold 225,000.
- 2 A hundred couples chose the name *James* in 2000, while just 20 couples opted for the name *Peter*.
- 3 It costs an average of £95 to spend a night in a hotel in Paris, as opposed to over £150 in Zurich.
- 4 The temperature in Rawai Island was much lower than in Phuket, at 15 degrees and 25 degrees respectively.

A further way to increase your range of language for describing comparatives is to use 'not + verb + as + noun phrase + as'.

Crooners plc did not sell as many CDs as Monster Hits Records in 1990, with 225,000 compared to 230,000.

Coffee in France does not cost as much as in the UK, at £2 and £2.90 respectively.

**Gold Medals,
Beijing Olympics, 2008**

China	62
USA	48
Russia	47
UK	42
France	33
Australia	21
Italy	19
Ethiopia	10
Japan	9
South Korea	5

Look at the table on the left and complete these sentences with 'not + (verb) + as + noun phrase + as'. Be careful, one sentence is different.

- 1 Japan did not Ethiopia, taking home nine compared to Ethiopia's ten.
- 2 The USA won 48 gold medals, but this was nowhere near China won.
- 3 The USA was China, winning 48 medals compared to 62.
- 4 Australia did not the French athletes, taking home 21 compared to France's 33.

Grammar Tips:

- **Use prepositions accurately:**
 - "Increased **by** 20%" (change) vs. "Increased **to** 50%" (final value).
 - From... to..., at..., by....
- **Tenses:**
 - Past: "In 1990, emissions were..."
 - Present Perfect: "Since 2010, emissions have risen..."

Add the missing prepositions to this paragraph.

If we look at Bernie's Buns, income started £20,000 in 2000, and then there was a slight rise £25,000 in 2001. At this point, the figure fell back just over £20,000, followed by a slight increase just under £40,000. Earnings then levelled off £39,000, and then fell marginally £38,000. Income then rose £23,000, £38,000 £61,000. In the next two years, there was a gradual rise around £62,000, and then the figure peaked around £65,000.

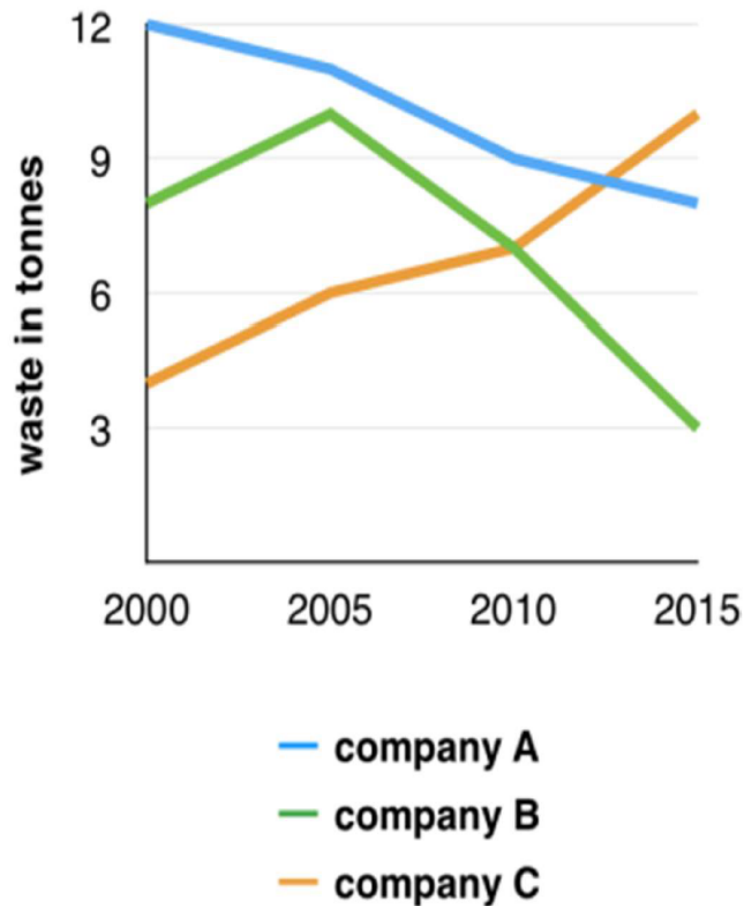
- 1 a Monster Hits Records sold 230,000 CDs in 1990, while Crooners plc sold 225,000.
- b Monster Hits Records sold 230,000 CDs in 1990, as opposed to Crooners plc, who sold 225,000.
- 2 a A hundred couples chose the name *James* in 2000, whereas just 20 couples opted for the name *Peter*.
- b A hundred couples chose the name *James* in 2000, compared to 20 who opted for the name *Peter*.

Correct the mistakes in these sentences.

- 1 Just 10% of first-time buyers said they needed a garage, as opposed to 30% said a large kitchen was necessary.
- 2 Just 10% of first-time buyers said they needed a garage, whereas 30% who said a large kitchen was necessary.

Writing Practice

The graph below shows the amounts of waste produced by three companies over a period of 15 years.



The line graph **compares** three companies **in terms of** their waste output between the years 2000 and 2015.

It is clear that there were significant changes in the amounts of waste produced by all three companies shown on the graph. **While** companies A and B saw waste output fall over the 15-year period, the amount of waste produced by company C increased considerably.

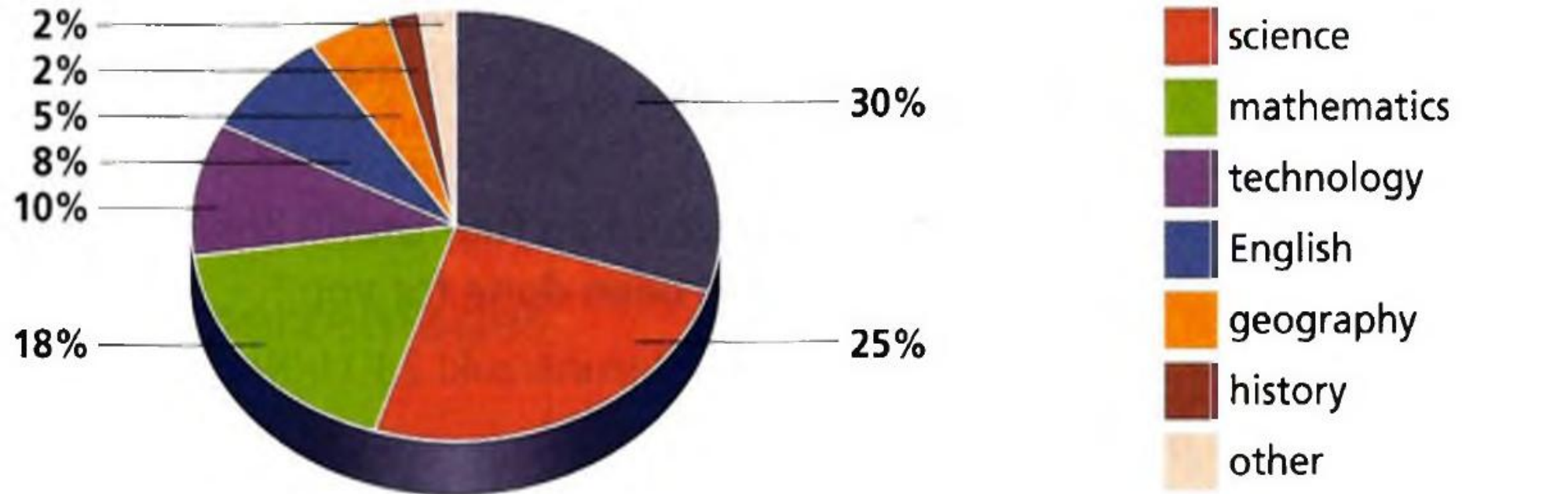
In 2000, company A produced 12 tonnes of waste, **while** companies B and C **produced around** 8 tonnes and 4 tonnes of waste material **respectively**. **Over the following 5 years**, the waste output of companies B and C **rose by around** 2 tonnes, but the figure for company A **fell by approximately** 1 tonne.

From 2005 to 2015, company A **cut waste production by roughly** 3 tonnes, and company B **reduced its waste by** around 7 tonnes. **By contrast**, company C **saw an increase in waste production of approximately** 4 tonnes over the same 10-year period. **By 2015**, company C's waste output had risen to 10 tonnes, **while the respective amounts of waste from companies A and B** had dropped to 8 tonnes and only 3 tonnes.

Step 3

Making Comparisons

Favourite school subjects for boys



The pie chart illustrates the percentage of boys' preferences for various school subjects, including physical education, science, mathematics, and others. **It highlights** which subjects are most and least favored among boys.

Overall, physical education is the most popular subject among boys. STEM subjects, including science, mathematics, and technology, **also** hold significant shares **compared to** liberal arts courses like English and geography. **In contrast**, history and others are far less popular, with minimal percentages.

To begin with, physical education dominates the chart, capturing nearly one-third of the boys' preferences. This strong inclination suggests that boys prioritize physical activity and sports over academic subjects. **Following closely**, STEM subjects, in general, also take up a major part (53%) of the chart. Science is the second most popular choice, with 25% of boys favoring it. Mathematics, **ranking third**, accounts for 18% of boys' preferences. Technology also holds a significant portion, with 10% of boys opting for it as their favorite.

On the other hand, English and geography are moderately favored, but their percentages are notably lower. English holds a smaller share at 8%, and geography is a favored choice for only 5% of boys.

Finally, history and other subjects are the least favored, each attracting a mere 2% of the total, highlighting their marginal popularity.

In summary, the data reveals a clear hierarchy: PE and STEM courses are prioritized over language-based or humanities subjects.

EAP Describing Graphs

THE END

